SHOPINBOS

FREE CHECKLIST · 2026 EDITION

First 90 Days Launch Checklist and Calendar

You have decided to start selling online. Now let us use a clear launch checklist so the road to your launch day becomes less confusing, one step at a time.



7 pages · PDF

shopinbos.com

What's inside

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You have decided to start selling online. Now let us use a clear launch checklist so the road to your launch day becomes less confusing, one step at a time.

This 90-day calendar breaks your journey into small weekly tasks. It removes the guesswork and helps you launch with confidence. Whether you make your own products, dropship from a supplier, or sell digital downloads, this plan works for complete beginners.

01 Days 1–30: Foundation and Planning

Your first month is about laying a strong foundation. Do not rush to build. Rushing now means redoing things later.

Weeks 1–2: Research and Decisions

- Choose what to sell based on what you love AND what people are buying (for example, ankara, hair, perfume oils, gadgets or zobo)
- Learn about your target customers: where they live, what they can afford, and how they like to pay
- Decide how you will run the business: dropship (the supplier sends to your customer after you sell), wholesale (you buy in bulk), or make it yourself
- Choose where you will sell: your own store, WhatsApp Business, Instagram, TikTok, Facebook, Jiji, Jumia or Konga
- Register your business name with the CAC, get your TIN, and secure a matching website name (domain)

Weeks 3–4: Products and Suppliers

- Source or make your first 5–10 products (start small!)
- Talk to suppliers about price and delivery, at Balogun, Trade Fair, Alaba, Onitsha, Aba or Kano markets, or through verified suppliers on Shopinbos
- Set prices that cover your costs and leave a profit
- Write strong product descriptions that show how the product helps the buyer
- Take clear, bright product photos with your phone in daylight

Toolkit Essential: Create a simple spreadsheet that tracks each product's cost, selling price and profit in naira. For example: cost ₦4,500, price ₦8,000, profit ₦3,500. This becomes your money compass for the whole journey.

02 Days 31–60: Build and Design

Month two is when your store comes to life. Your checklist now moves to building the shopping experience.

Weeks 5–6: Store Design and Setup

- Pick and adjust your store design (keep it simple!). On Shopinbos, Rex the AI store builder can create your store for you
- Set up the main pages: Home, Shop, About, Contact
- Turn on payments customers trust: Paystack or Flutterwave for cards and transfers, plus bank transfer, USSD and pay on delivery
- Set up delivery: choose partners like GIG Logistics, Kwik Delivery, Sendbox or local dispatch riders, and set clear fees for Lagos, Abuja, Port Harcourt, Ibadan and other cities
- Create your logo and basic brand colours

Weeks 7–8: Content and Legal

- Write your store policies (privacy policy, terms, and return and refund policy)
- Set up Google Analytics, Search Console and a Google Business Profile
- Prepare order confirmation and delivery update messages for email and WhatsApp
- Build a simple FAQ page answering common questions (“Do you deliver to Kano?”, “Can I pay on delivery?”)
- Set up a business email address with your own domain, and a separate WhatsApp Business number

Toolkit Essential: Use free tools like Canva for graphics, Grammarly for writing, and TinyPNG to make images smaller so your store loads fast on mobile data. These save money and still look good.

03 Days 61–90: Testing and Launch

The final month focuses on testing everything and attracting your first customers.

Weeks 9–10: Full Testing

- Place test orders on a phone and on a computer
- Check that every link on your store works
- Make sure your emails arrive in the inbox (not spam) and your WhatsApp messages send properly
- Test checkout with every payment method: card, transfer, USSD and pay on delivery

- Ask friends and family to try your store and tell you what is confusing

Week 11: Pre-Launch Marketing

- Build your contact list with a "coming soon" page and a WhatsApp broadcast list
- Set up your Instagram, TikTok and Facebook pages and post regularly
- Write your first 3–5 blog posts so people can find you on Google
- Reach out to local influencers, content creators or businesses you can partner with
- Prepare launch-day offers, such as a discount or free delivery within your city

Week 12: Launch and First Sales

- Go live on your chosen launch date
- Send announcement messages to your email and WhatsApp lists
- Post your launch on WhatsApp Status, Instagram, TikTok and Facebook
- Watch your numbers and fix any problems straight away
- Reply quickly to your first customer questions (Peggy, the Shopinbos AI assistant, can help with chats)

Toolkit Essential: Keep a launch-day checklist close: make sure all products are published, switch off test mode on your payment provider, remove any "coming soon" banners, and announce your launch.

04 Your Essential Beginner Toolkit

Free Tools to Get Started:

- **Google Analytics:** See who visits your store and what they buy
- **Google Search Console:** See how people find you on Google
- **Google Business Profile:** Show up on Google Maps and search in your area
- **Canva:** Create graphics and social media posts
- **Mailchimp or Brevo (free plan):** Build and manage email lists
- **WhatsApp Business:** Catalogue, quick replies and broadcast lists
- **Answer the Public:** Find questions customers ask, for content ideas

Paid Items Worth Spending On (prices change, so check before you pay):

- **Your own domain name (.com.ng or .com):** a yearly fee that makes you look more trustworthy
- **Business email:** a small monthly fee per user, often billed in US dollars

- **Product photos:** a local photographer for a few hours, or a stock photo subscription (billed in US dollars) if you cannot photograph your own products

05 After Launch: Day 91 and Beyond

Your checklist does not end at launch. The first 30 days after going live are very important for getting feedback and making things better.

Focus on great customer service, ask early buyers for reviews (a screenshot of a happy WhatsApp message counts!), check your numbers to see what is working, adjust prices or descriptions based on results, and keep posting content that brings in free visitors.

06 Common Beginner Mistakes to Avoid

Waiting for perfection: Launch with 5–10 good products, not 100 average ones. You can always add more later.

Skipping phone testing: Most of your customers will shop on their phones, often on mobile data. If your store does not work well on a phone, you lose them.

No marketing plan: Building a store without a plan to bring visitors is like opening a shop in an empty street. Decide how you will attract people before launch day.

Ignoring the basics of trust: Missing return policies, delivery information or CAC registration makes customers doubt you and can cause problems later.

07 Ready to Start Your Journey?

This 90-day checklist turns the big job of starting an online business into small weekly goals. Take it step by step, tick off tasks as you go, and celebrate small wins.

Remember, every successful seller, from Tunde with his gadgets in Ikeja to Halima with her perfume oils in Kano, started where you are now: unsure but willing to take the first step. Your first 90 days build the foundation for everything that follows.

At Shopinbos, we provide guides, templates and tools for every stage of your journey. From finding products to getting paid every Friday, we help first-time sellers turn their online business dream into real profit.

Download this checklist, print it or save it on your phone, and start with day one. Your future customers are waiting.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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